

CATHARSIS 14-DAY WORKSHOP

The Overthinking Reset

A two-week workshop for leaving the mental loop and returning to your body, your values, and one clear next step.

14 days of teaching, reflection, scripts, tiny practices, and on-screen reset pages. About 5 minutes a day.

START HERE

This is not about thinking less. It is about trusting better.

Overthinking often begins as protection. It tries to prevent regret, rejection, conflict, embarrassment, or loss by analyzing every possible angle.

The cost is that your mind gets more information while your body gets less safety. This workshop helps you notice the loop, regulate the state underneath it, and choose action without needing perfect certainty.

Use one day at a time. You do not need to finish perfectly for the work to count.

The question is not: how do I stop having thoughts? The question is: what helps me stop obeying every thought?

Use this as education, not therapy

This guide is for reflection, emotional education, and self-support. It is not therapy, diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for professional care.

If your distress feels unmanageable, you feel unsafe, or daily life is becoming hard to function through, speak with a qualified mental health professional or local crisis support.

For digital use, open the PDF in Apple Preview, Adobe Reader, Chrome, Edge, or the Google Drive PDF viewer and type directly into the writable boxes. Google Docs may flatten PDF forms, so use the Drive preview/editor instead of converting the file to a Doc.

If you print it, choose black-and-white or grayscale settings to save ink. Aim for about 5 minutes a day; short, honest answers are better than perfect answers.

What the 14 days are really training

The reset moves from awareness to regulation, then into decisions, communication, and self-trust.

PHASE 1

Name the loop

Replay, prediction, decoding, and decision loops lose power when they become visible.

PHASE 2

Change the state

A calmer body can evaluate thoughts without treating every one as an emergency.

PHASE 3

Choose the next step

The aim is one honest action, not a guarantee that nothing will hurt.

PHASE 4

Rebuild self-trust

Small kept promises teach the mind that you can handle uncertainty.

SCRIPTS

Words for the moment your mind gets loud

WHEN SILENCE BECOMES A STORY

I can notice the story without treating it as confirmed information.

WHEN I WANT CERTAINTY

I am allowed to act from enough information, not perfect information.

WHEN I WANT TO TEXT AGAIN

I can wait until I am asking for clarity, not chasing relief.

WHEN A DECISION FEELS DANGEROUS

This choice does not need to protect every future version of me.

WHEN I SPIRAL AT NIGHT

Night thoughts are allowed to be loud. They do not get to make every decision.

BEFORE A MEETING

I can prepare the point, not rehearse every possible reaction.

BEFORE CONFRONTATION

I can be clear without proving I deserve to speak.

AFTER I HIT SEND

A sent message is allowed to exist without being reread into a crisis.

WHEN COMPARISON STARTS

Someone else's timeline is not evidence against my life.

WHEN I MADE A MISTAKE

Repair is available.
Self-punishment is not the same as accountability.

BEFORE YOU START

Mark your starting point

This is not a scorecard. It is a snapshot you can return to after the final day.

Right now, my overthinking reset intensity is: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

The pattern I most want to shift is:

If this workshop helps, I hope I will notice:

Catch the loop before it becomes the room

Today is about noticing your overthinking pattern early. The first few minutes matter because the loop is still flexible before it becomes a full story.

At this stage, do not try to solve the whole situation. Your first win is catching the moment a thought turns into a room you are living inside.

Today's reset: Write the sentence your loop repeats most often. Label it as replay, prediction, decoding, or decision. The practice gives the loop a name. Once it has a name, it becomes something you can relate to instead of something you have to obey.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Catch the loop before it becomes the room

TODAY'S RESET

Write the sentence your loop repeats most often. Label it as replay, prediction, decoding, or decision.

Today's reset pairs with the Overthinking deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The situation my mind keeps returning to is:

The loop type is:

The fear underneath the loop might be:

Separate facts from fear

Overthinking becomes sticky when facts, interpretations, and fears collapse into one urgent truth. Pulling them apart gives your nervous system more room.

Fear often speaks in a finished tone. Separating the evidence from the prediction lowers the pressure to treat every possible outcome as already proven.

Today's reset: Make three short columns: facts, stories, and unknowns. Do not force a conclusion. You are not dismissing your intuition. You are giving it cleaner material to work with.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Separate facts from fear

TODAY'S RESET

Make three short columns: facts, stories, and unknowns. Do not force a conclusion.

Today's reset pairs with the Reality Check deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The plain facts are:

The story my fear adds is:

The unknowns I cannot solve today are:

Find the body cue

The loop is not only in your head. It usually has a body signature: jaw, chest, stomach, throat, shoulders, breathing, or checking behavior.

The body usually knows the loop has started before the mind admits it. A tight jaw, held breath, or restless checking habit is useful data.

Today's reset: Pause for 60 seconds and scan your body before thinking more. When you answer the body cue first, the thought often becomes less absolute.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Find the body cue

TODAY'S RESET

Pause for 60 seconds and scan your body before thinking more.

Today's reset pairs with the Body Scan deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

My strongest body cue is:

This cue usually makes me want to:

One way I can soften the cue is:

Stop debating every thought

A thought can be loud without being wise. If you argue with every anxious thought, the loop learns that every thought deserves a trial.

Debating every thought can make anxiety feel like the judge, jury, and witness. You are allowed to notice a thought without entering the courtroom.

Today's reset: Instead of asking if the thought is true, ask what state you are in while thinking it. The useful question is not only whether the thought is true. It is whether this is the state you want making decisions.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Stop debating every thought

TODAY'S RESET

Instead of asking if the thought is true, ask what state you are in while thinking it.

Today's reset pairs with the Thought Defusion deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The thought demanding attention is:

The state I am in right now is:

From a steadier state, this thought might need:

Use the 90-second reset

You are not trying to become magically calm. You are creating enough space to choose instead of react.

A reset is not a performance of calm. It is a short interruption in the chain between fear and action.

Today's reset: Feet down. Longer exhale. Unclench jaw. Name the loop. Say: I do not have to solve everything from this state. Ninety seconds can be enough to create a little choice where urgency was about to take over.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Use the 90-second reset

TODAY'S RESET

Feet down. Longer exhale. Unclench jaw. Name the loop. Say: I do not have to solve everything from this state.

Today's reset pairs with the Nervous System deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

Before the reset I felt:

After the reset I noticed:

The next smallest step is:

Replace certainty with enough information

Overthinking often waits for impossible certainty. Real life usually asks for enough information to take the next honest step.

Certainty is seductive because it promises a future with no regret. Most real decisions only offer a workable threshold, not a guarantee.

Today's reset: Define what enough information looks like before you gather more. Defining enough information protects research, rereading, and polling from becoming another hiding place.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Replace certainty with enough information

TODAY'S RESET

Define what enough information looks like before you gather more.

Today's reset pairs with the Decision Clarity deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The decision or worry is:

Enough information would be:

More information would become avoidance when:

Practice the pause before checking

Checking can feel like relief, but frequent reassurance keeps the loop in charge. A pause teaches your body that urgency is not the same as danger.

Checking gives quick relief and then quietly teaches the loop to ask again. The pause is uncomfortable because it interrupts that contract.

Today's reset: Wait ten minutes before checking, texting, refreshing, rereading, or researching. Ten minutes is not about being strong. It is about showing the body that urgency can rise and fall without being fed immediately.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Practice the pause before checking

TODAY'S RESET

Wait ten minutes before checking, texting, refreshing, rereading, or researching.

Today's reset pairs with the Reassurance Loop deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The checking urge showed up when:

Waiting felt like:

What I learned from the pause was:

Ask one clean question

If the loop is about another person, your mind may collect clues forever. Sometimes the kindest move is one direct question.

Decoding another person can feel safer than asking because the question makes the uncertainty visible. But endless interpretation can become its own kind of loneliness.

Today's reset: Write the cleanest question you could ask without overexplaining. One clean question respects both people more than a hundred private guesses.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Ask one clean question

TODAY'S RESET

Write the cleanest question you could ask without overexplaining.

Today's reset pairs with the Communication deck in the Catharsis Cards app.
Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The behavior I keep decoding is:

The question I am avoiding is:

The clean version is:

Interrupt the 1am loop

Nighttime overthinking has a different texture. The body is tired, the room is quiet, and the mind can mistake exhaustion for evidence.

Low-stakes choices are where self-trust gets reps without needing a dramatic life event. The point is to practice choosing while uncertainty is still present.

Today's reset: Create a night rule: no solving after midnight. Write the thought down, name one next-day action, and return to rest. You are teaching your mind that imperfect information is not automatically danger.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Interrupt the lam loop

TODAY'S RESET

Create a night rule: no solving after midnight. Write the thought down, name one next-day action, and return to rest.

Today's reset pairs with the Sleep Spiral deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The thought that gets louder at night is:

Tomorrow's container for it is:

My no-solving sentence is:

Notice reassurance loops

Reassurance is human. The loop begins when reassurance becomes a requirement before you can function.

Reassurance can be care. It becomes a loop when your system needs another hit of certainty before it can breathe.

Today's reset: Track where you seek repeated certainty from people, apps, search, or rereading. Tracking the source of reassurance helps you see whether you are seeking support or outsourcing permission to feel okay.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Notice reassurance loops

TODAY'S RESET

Track where you seek repeated certainty from people, apps, search, or rereading.

Today's reset pairs with the Self-Trust deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

I seek reassurance from:

The feeling I want reassurance to remove is:

A steadier substitute could be:

Use values as a compass

Values do not remove discomfort, but they stop fear from being the only voice in the room.

Values are steadier than fear because they do not need the future to be fully controlled. They point toward the kind of person you want to be in the uncertainty.

Today's reset: Name the value you want to honor in the situation you are overthinking. A value-led step may still feel uncomfortable. That does not mean it is wrong.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Use values as a compass

TODAY'S RESET

Name the value you want to honor in the situation you are overthinking.

Today's reset pairs with the Values deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The value I want to honor is:

Fear is pushing me toward:

A value-led next step is:

Let the imperfect action count

Overthinking tells you that action only counts if it is perfectly timed, perfectly worded, and perfectly safe. Real repair and progress are messier.

Overthinking often delays action until the wording, timing, and outcome feel protected. Life rarely gives that much protection before it asks you to participate.

Today's reset: Take one imperfect action that moves the situation forward by 5 percent. A five percent action counts because it interrupts the fantasy that progress has to arrive fully formed.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Let the imperfect action count

TODAY'S RESET

Take one imperfect action that moves the situation forward by 5 percent.

Today's reset pairs with the Imperfect Action deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The imperfect action is:

The discomfort I expect is:

Why it still counts:

Review the pattern with kindness

The goal is not to shame the loop. The goal is to understand what it was protecting so you can offer that part something better.

The overthinking part is usually trying to prevent pain, not create it. Shame makes it louder because it adds another threat to manage.

Today's reset: Write a compassionate note to the part of you that overthinks. Kind review helps you keep the protection while changing the strategy.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Review the pattern with kindness

TODAY'S RESET

Write a compassionate note to the part of you that overthinks.

Today's reset pairs with the Self-Compassion deck in the Catharsis Cards app. Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

Dear overthinking part, I see that you are trying to:

What I can offer you instead is:

What I no longer need you to carry alone is:

Create your future reset plan

You will overthink again because you are human. The win is having a practiced path back.

The goal is not to graduate into a mind that never loops. The goal is to know the path back sooner.

Today's reset: Build a three-step plan: cue, reset, next action. A future plan turns this workshop into something portable: cue, reset, next action.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Create your future reset plan

TODAY'S RESET

Build a three-step plan: cue, reset, next action.

Today's reset pairs with the Future Reset deck in the Catharsis Cards app.
Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

My earliest cue is:

My reset will be:

My next action rule will be:

Compare the shift

Use the same questions from day zero so the change is visible, even if the shift is small.

Today, my overthinking reset intensity is: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Compared with day zero, I can see:

The reset I want to keep using is:

Daily workshop tracker

Tap or annotate one short note per day. Keep it short enough to complete even on a messy day.

Day	Body cue	Old pattern	Reset used	What I learned
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

You are allowed to be unfinished and still choose.

The reset is not a promise that your mind will never loop again. It is proof that you can notice the loop, return to your body, and choose one honest step without abandoning yourself.

I can move with uncertainty and still belong to myself.

RESOURCES

Continue with Catharsis

Keep going with the app, or visit Catharsis for more reflection tools.

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website

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One prompt. One honest answer. One small act
of self-trust.